

Publisher's Note

Wish List for the year ahead



Maulik Jasubhai

Every year in our anniversary issue, I am expected to write about our vision and plans for the coming year. This year, I have decided to do away with the Vision mumbo jumbo! Instead, here's my Wish List for the computer industry in India:

- 1. Computers for everybody:** Technology giants have promised us, many a times, to bring and build an affordable computer. While there has been some progress on this front, the real ticket is the Rs 10,000 computer.
- 2. Software in OUR languages:** Why is it that all the software giants (read Microsoft), can invest more than \$100 million in developing Chinese language versions and not make a slightest of dent in putting together a 'local' language software for India?
- 3. Internet for the masses (Finally!):** I hope that in 2003, the Internet—infrastructure efforts such as DSL and satellite; content such as Web sites, e-mail and other services; access and usage by wider groups—will finally begin to work.
Huge sections of our people do not, yet, have access to Internet. Until now, limited access also caused limited content. I hope that in 2003, the Internet will grow into a real World Wide Web, and finally begin to contribute to solutions for the many problems of poor education, promote economic growth and make us as a truly 'technology-enabled' country.
- 4. Substance, NOT Speed:** How much faster do you need your processor to be to load MS Word? Enough! Can someone please ask the technology industry to wake up and smell the coffee?! We have all the speed we need; now can we have software and content and connectivity to actually use that speed?! Moore's law, RIP. What we really need are user-focused innovations. Tech industry has been the fountainhead of innovations (heck, the auto industry, after a century, is still stuck on the internal combustion engine). But we need innovations for the 'Human Being', not for the number-crunching monsters.

5. Surprise ME!

Tell me your Wish List at maulik44@jasubhai.com

We promise to continue to work tirelessly to make your wishes come true.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Maulik Jasubhai'.

Maulik Jasubhai
Publisher and Executive Director, Jasubhai Digital Media